

MODERN HISTORY

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

Syllabus review

Once a course syllabus has been accredited by the School Curriculum and Standards Authority, the implementation of that syllabus will be monitored by the Course Advisory Committee. This committee can advise the Board of the Authority about any need for syllabus review. Syllabus change deemed to be minor requires schools to be notified of the change at least six months before implementation. Major syllabus change requires schools to be notified 18 months before implementation. Formal processes of syllabus review and requisite reaccreditation will apply.

Other sources of information

The Western Australian Certificate of Education (WACE) Manual contains essential information on assessment, moderation and examinations that need to be read in conjunction with this course.

The School Curriculum and Standards Authority website www.scsa.wa.edu.au and extranet provides support materials including sample programs, course outlines, assessment outlines, assessment tasks with marking keys, past WACE examinations with marking keys, grade descriptions with annotated student work samples and standards guides.

WACE providers

Throughout this document the term 'school' is intended to include both schools and other WACE providers.

Currency

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Rationale

History is the study and practice of making meaning of the past with a view to understanding the present. It engages us with the ideas, beliefs and values that shape and influence our lives. At the same time it helps us clarify our own beliefs and values compared to those of others. Studying Modern History provides enjoyment and the knowledge gained reveals the background and some of the driving forces behind present local and global issues. Investigating the past helps students to understand why and how groups and/or societies changed or resisted changes.

A study of Modern History enables students to become critical thinkers. The skills and knowledge gained from this course inform judgements and actions in a rapidly changing world. History provides insights into the present, and gives students an informed basis for determining their decisions and provides opportunities to reflect on the significance of past events, people, beliefs and ideas and how and why they are valued now. Historical inquiry reveals that there are various perspectives and interpretations of past events and actions. These varying interpretations of history can provoke heated debate in the classroom, the media and in the political arena.

The Modern History course promotes skills of research, hypothesis testing and analysis of information as students engage with investigations. Through inquiries, they learn that historical judgements are provisional and tentative in nature. They are encouraged to question and evaluate historical sources; to identify the various representations and versions of history. The study of history assists them in the development of critical thinking skills as it encourages them to compare and contrast information, detect inconsistencies in details, recognise the manipulation of evidence, identify perspective in the presentation of graphic and textual material, and evaluate the accuracy and reliability of sources. They are exposed to a variety of historical sources including artefacts, speeches, songs, oral stories, photographs, film, drawings, diary extracts and other written accounts in order to determine the cause and effect, and the motives and forces influencing people and events. They are encouraged to use the evidence from sources to formulate and support their own interpretations and to communicate their findings in a variety of ways.

The Modern History course allows students to gain insights into their own society and its values, and provides an avenue for understanding the human condition. It helps them to understand why nations and people hold certain values, and why values and belief systems vary from one group to another. This knowledge is crucial to the development of active and informed citizens in any society. The study of history ensures that they gain essential knowledge of the past—its legacy and heritage—and that they

become aware of the cumulative and tentative nature of human knowledge.

Students benefit from acquiring the literacy skills of the discipline of history such as critical thinking, research, analysis and effective written expression. These skills equip them for a world changed and linked by information and communication technology and prepare them for lifelong learning. Through study of societies, movements and political structures, they are well prepared for careers involving policy making, administration and research. Learning the skills of critical inquiry is essential for people working in business, government, law, health, science, academia, industry, tourism, environment, media and the arts.

Course outcomes

The Modern History course is designed to facilitate the achievement of four outcomes.

Outcome 1: Historical investigation, communication and participation

Students apply the skills of historical inquiry and methodology to investigate the past and communicate their findings using the discourse of history.

In achieving this outcome, students:

- plan ways to organise and gather information for an historical inquiry;
- conduct an historical inquiry using and evaluating a variety of sources of evidence;
- process and synthesise information to make historical findings/judgements; and
- reflect on, apply and communicate findings according to purpose and audience.

Outcome 2: Understanding the past

Students understand the past, linking the chronology of people, events, ideas and distinctive features of society into an historical narrative.

In achieving this outcome, students:

- understand that time periods have chronologies with distinctive features, people and events;
- understand that a variety of ideas, values and beliefs exist at a particular time in a society and that some are more influential than others; and
- understand that societies have a range of organisational structures which impact on people and events.

Outcome 3: Continuity and change

Students understand the nature of forces, the interaction between forces and their significance for continuity and change in an historical context.

In achieving this outcome, students:

- understand the nature of the forces in a society that are responsible for continuity and change;
- understand how historical forces operate and interact to bring about both continuity and change; and

- understand that some forces are more significant than others in bringing about continuity and change.

Outcome 4: Interpretations and perspectives

Students understand that interpretations and perspectives of people and events may change over time.

In achieving this outcome, students:

- understand that there are different interpretations and perspectives of people, events and ideas;
- understand how interpretations and perspectives at a particular time are shaped by a variety of influences; and
- understand that the way the past is viewed changes over time.

Course contexts

Within each unit there are a variety of contexts from which to choose. Students cannot repeat a context in a different unit.

In the WACE examination, each prescribed context in either Stage 2 or Stage 3 will be examined in an essay and a document study.

Note:

1. For the purpose of Section One: Document study of the examination, there is a choice of three time periods in the Australian context. These time periods are:
1880–1929
OR
1920–1959
OR
1950–1999.

In any one year, the Australian documents in Section One of the examination could draw from one or more of the following forces:

- economic
- political
- leadership
- international relations and international conflicts
- social/cultural e.g. Aboriginal peoples, migrants, women, sport, environment
- identity.

For their examination students will have to have studied ONE of these three time periods in the Australian context. These time periods are found in the 2A and 3A units.

2. For the purpose of Section Three: Document study of the Stage 2 examination, the documents will come from **the prescribed learning contexts in the 2B unit.**

Course content

The course content is the focus of the learning program.

The course content is divided into three content areas:

- historical thinking and methodology
- working with historical narratives
- historical explanation and representation.

Historical thinking and methodology

In developing an understanding of historical thinking, skills and processes, students evaluate, interpret, and undertake comparative and causal analyses of data and evidence to make meaning of the past. As they learn to formulate their own historical narratives or accounts, they develop an understanding of the ethical requirements of an historical investigation, develop a range of inquiry skills and construct sound and informed arguments about the past. In learning about historical thinking and methodology, they should be taught skills relevant to:

Constructing historical inquiry

In constructing an historical inquiry, students identify, locate and select from a range of historical evidence and narratives. They learn that the development of an hypothesis or a proposition with a clear idea of the issue or problem to be investigated along with the role and importance of evidence is the foundation of an effective historical inquiry.

Students should be taught skills relevant to:

- identifying issues and problems to investigate as part of an historical inquiry
- formulating propositions/hypotheses and historical questions for the purpose of an historical inquiry
- locating, identifying and selecting historical evidence for an historical inquiry.

Interpreting, analysing and synthesising information

Students develop skills to examine and evaluate evidence and data collected as part of an historical investigation. By doing this, they develop an understanding that the nature and availability of evidence may require them to modify questions, hypotheses/propositions, construct additional questions or conduct additional research in order to begin drafting conclusions about a selected problem or issue.

Students should be taught skills relevant to:

- interpreting and analysing historical information, narratives and perspectives
- identifying gaps in evidence, contextual knowledge, perspectives of the time and place
- drafting conclusions based on evidence collected.

Communicating findings

Students learn how the findings, explanations and analysis of an historical inquiry are communicated using the language and features of historical narratives. They develop the skills to communicate the findings of an historical inquiry according to purpose and audience. In doing so, they develop an understanding of the methods and techniques used to communicate and support a particular perspective as well as the ethical considerations to be taken into account when communicating findings.

Students should be taught skills relevant to:

- forms of communication used to convey historical positions or ideas
- selecting forms of communication to suit purpose and audience
- presenting findings according to purpose and audience.

Working with historical narratives

In order for students to make meaning of the past, they examine a range of historical narratives to develop understandings about the chronology of a time period. They examine the defining characteristics of a society at the start of the period; the key people, ideas and events that were forces for continuity and change during the period; and the consequences of continuity and change on a society at the time, at a later time and/or upon other societies. Through the study of a range of historical narratives, they learn that historical narratives are set within a defined period of time, reflect a particular view of history which may be similar to, or different from other historical narratives and are different from fictional narratives in that they are supported with evidence. In learning about historical narratives, students should be taught about the:

Elements of a society at the start of the period

Through an examination of historical narratives, students develop an understanding of the defining features of a society at the start of the period. They develop knowledge of the shared and prevailing ideas, values, beliefs and experiences which have contributed to the degree of cohesion or division that may exist in a society at a particular time.

Students should be taught about the:

- shared values, beliefs and traditions of the society—*what are the beliefs and ideologies of the society?*
- political, economic and social organisational structures of the society—*how is the society organised?*
- key events, people, ideas and other factors that have influenced the society to that point —*what shaped this society?*

Key people, ideas and events over the period

Through an examination of historical narratives, students understand the ways in which ideas, people and events present challenges to the cohesion of a society at a particular time. They explore the causal links between continuity and change and the motivations and actions of individuals and groups within a society and their level of support or opposition during the period.

Students should be taught about the:

- key ideas shaping continuity and change over the period
- key events that shaped the period of study
- individuals and groups seeking continuity and change
- level of support or opposition for individuals, groups, ideas and events.

Consequences of continuity and change over the period

Through an examination of historical narratives, students learn about the range of forces that operate within a society to bring about continuity and change. They learn about the relationship between the nature of forces that exist at a particular time and why some forces are more powerful or significant than others in contributing to different levels of continuity and change in society over the period.

Students should be taught about the:

- nature of forces which contribute to continuity and change in a society
- pace, scale and extent of continuity and change over time
- impact of continuity and change
- responses to continuity and change.

Historical explanation and representation

When analysing evidence, historical narratives and debates, students develop understandings about the provisional nature of the knowledge held about the past. By examining a range of explanations and representations of past people, ideas and events, they go beyond the mere explanation of historical fact and consider the role of the narrator (historians and others) and their position in society within the context of the time in which the narrative was composed. They understand that perspectives about the past can reflect shared and prevailing values, beliefs, traditions and experiences of individuals and groups, as well as the nature and interpretation of evidence available at the time. By assessing a range of perspectives about the past, they are provided with the opportunity to discover the importance of historical empathy in understanding how and why historical narratives are developed or constructed in different ways at different times and then are often challenged or further endorsed at later times. In learning about how the past is explained and represented, students should be taught about:

Explanations and representation of the past

Students develop an understanding about the role of the historian in reconstructing the past. By examining a variety of explanations and representations of past people, events and ideas, they learn about the ways evidence is interpreted and used to support a particular version of history and the reasons why these versions change over time.

Students should be taught about:

- different explanations and representations of history in the present and in the past
- how and why explanations and representations of history change over time
- the way evidence is used to support a particular explanation or representation of the past
- nature and problems of evidence and how it influences the interpretations made by individuals and groups.

Understanding perspective

Students, through an examination of past and present perspectives, develop understandings and empathy for past people, events and ideas.

Students should be taught about:

- what is meant by perspective
- the influence of societal values, beliefs, traditions, attitudes and experiences on past and contemporary perspectives of individuals and groups
- connections between explanations and representations of the past and perspective.

Course units

Each unit is defined with a particular focus and a selection of learning contexts through which the specific unit content can be taught and learnt. The cognitive difficulty of the content increases with each stage. The pitch of the content for each stage is notional and there will be overlap between stages.

Stage 1 units provide bridging support and a practical and applied focus to help students develop skills required to be successful for Stage 2 units.

Stage 2 units provide opportunities for applied learning but there is a focus more on academic learning.

Stage 3 units provide opportunities to extend knowledge and understandings in challenging prescribed learning contexts.

Unit 1AHIM

The focus for this unit is **people, place and time**. The object of this unit is to allow students to become aware of the broad sweep of history and our place within the historical narrative.

Students become aware of the values, beliefs and traditions within a society, the continuity between different societies and different time periods and the importance of individuals within a time period. They learn the basis of some traditions and values, and the importance of knowing one's history and heritage.

This unit introduces students to the historian's methods of finding and communicating reliable information gained from a variety of primary and secondary sources. It allows them to develop inquiry skills, develop different forms of communicating findings and to use ethical behaviour when communicating those findings.

Unit 1BHIM

The focus for this unit is **power and authority**. Students learn that societies consist of individuals and institutions that have various types of power and authority and that these interact with each other.

Students learn how power and authority is distributed throughout a group or society, that individuals and groups seek to influence the structures of power and authority and the difficulties of using these structures in a just or equitable manner. In learning about the structures and institutions of societies, they make comparisons and judgements about other societies and their own society.

In this unit, students develop critical thinking skills related to comparing and contrasting information, distinguish between the usefulness of sources and understand that there are different points of view and alternative accounts of history.

Unit 2AHIM

The focus for this unit is **societies and change**. Students learn about the evolving nature of societies and the various forces for continuity and change that exist.

Students learn that some values, beliefs and traditions are linked to the identity of a society. They also learn that in any period of change there are those individuals and institutions that support change but others that oppose it; and that there are different interpretations of the resultant society.

In this unit, students learn to develop propositions/hypotheses with supporting arguments, use appropriate strategies for selecting, recording and organising information and question the usefulness of evidence. They communicate findings that reflect the purpose and audience of the investigation.

Unit 2BHIM

The focus for this unit is **historical trends and movements**. Students understand that throughout history there have been events, ideas, beliefs and values that have contributed to underlying historical trends and movements.

Students understand that historical trends and movements have particular underlying ideas, that different methods and strategies are used to achieve change and that there are consequences for continuity and change. Some perspectives are omitted and others emphasised, both during the period of the trend or movement and subsequent to the trend or movement.

In this unit, students are able to justify their choice of sources, draw inferences based on key elements and communicate findings in ways that show consideration of differing perspectives and justify a particular viewpoint.

Unit 3AHIM

The focus for this unit is **cohesion and division**. Students learn that there are internal and external forces that result in cohesion and/or division within Australian society and these have consequences for continuity and change.

Students assess how the structures of power and authority lead to cohesion and/or division, how different groups and individuals responded and whether there was greater cohesion or division evident in Australian society as a result.

Students develop the skill of drafting conclusions or findings that present balanced arguments. Such conclusions show a consideration of different perspectives and acknowledge the problematical nature of the construction and accuracy of past explanations and representations.

Unit 3BHIM

The focus for this unit is **ideas that shaped history**. The object of this unit is to explore the power of ideas and ideologies as forces for change and/or their use to reinforce dominant elements in society.

Knowledge about the evolution and spread of significant ideas assists students to understand the beliefs and values of a society and to what extent these ideas have been cohesive or divisive. They are also able to determine which ideas were forces for continuity and change.

Students are able to identify and evaluate sources that contain a range of viewpoints and interpretations of the ideas being studied and be able to discuss how changing perspectives about past events, people and ideas challenge explanations and representations of the past.

Time and completion requirements

The notional hours for each unit are 55 class contact hours. Units can be delivered typically in a semester or in a designated time period up to a year depending on the needs of the students. Pairs of units can also be delivered concurrently over a one year period. Schools are encouraged to be flexible in their timetabling in order to meet the needs of all of their students.

Refer to the WACE Manual for more information about unit and course completion.

Resources

Teacher support materials are available on the School Curriculum and Standards Authority website extranet and can be found at www.scsa.wa.edu.au

Vocational Education and Training information

Vocational Education and Training (VET) is nationally recognised training that provides people with occupational knowledge and skills and credit towards, or attainment of, a vocational education and training qualification under the Australian Qualifications Framework (AQF).

When considering VET delivery in WACE courses it is necessary to:

- refer to the WACE Manual, Section 5: Vocational Education and Training, and
- contact education sector/systems representatives for information on operational issues concerning VET delivery options in schools.

Australian Quality Training Framework (AQTF)

AQTF is the quality system that underpins the national vocational education and training sector and outlines the regulatory arrangements in states and territories. It provides the basis for a nationally consistent, high-quality VET system.

The AQTF Essential Conditions and Standards for Registered Training Organisations outline a set of auditable standards that must be met and maintained for registration as a training provider in Australia.

VET integrated delivery

VET integrated within a WACE course involves students undertaking one or more VET units of competency concurrently with a WACE course unit. No unit equivalence is given for units of competency attained in this way.

VET integrated can be delivered by schools providing they meet AQTF requirements. Schools need to become a Registered Training Organisation (RTO) or work in a partnership arrangement with an RTO to deliver training within the scope for which they are registered. If a school operates in partnership with an RTO, it will be the responsibility of the RTO to assure the quality of the training delivery and assessment.

Assessment

The WACE Manual contains essential information on principles, policies and procedures for school-based assessment and WACE examinations that needs to be read in conjunction with this document.

School-based assessment

The table below provides details of the assessment types for this course and the weighting range for each assessment type.

Teachers are required to use the assessment table to develop their own assessment outline for each unit (or pair of units) of the course.

This outline includes a range of assessment tasks and indicates the weighting for each task and each assessment type. It also indicates the content and course outcomes each task covers.

If a pair of units is assessed using a combined assessment outline, the assessment requirements must still be met for each unit.

In developing an assessment outline and teaching program the following guidelines should be taken into account.

- All assessment tasks should take into account the teaching, learning and assessment principles outlined in the WACE Manual.
- There is flexibility for teachers to design school-based assessment tasks to meet the learning needs of students.
- The assessment table outlines the forms of student response required for this course.
- Student work submitted to demonstrate achievement should only be accepted if the teacher can attest that, to the best of her/his knowledge, all uncited work is the student's own.
- Evidence collected for each unit must include assessment tasks conducted under test conditions together with other forms of assessment tasks.

Assessment table

Weightings for types			Type of assessment
Stage 1	Stage 2	Stage 3	
30–50%	20–30%	20–30%	Historical inquiry Process of construction of an historical inquiry: framing or asking of a range of questions and/or constructing of a hypothesis; selection, collection and evaluation of a range of evidence (primary, secondary, historical representations) that may include evidence such as legal documents, oral, practical fieldwork and/or media material; critical analysis and interpretation of the evidence; and communicating using the discourse of History. Using historical evidence to develop an informed, balanced judgement about the past including concepts such as the impact of features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past. Findings may be communicated in different ways such as using short or extended written work, a timeline, a museum display, re-enactment of an event, recreation of historical clothing and food, completion of an historic trail, a multimedia presentation, historical debate or hypothetical. Types of evidence when focusing on the process may include: student learning journals, student annotations, student summarising tables, in combination with the final product. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1 and will also enable collection of evidence for Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>
10–30%	20–30%	20–30%	Explanation Explanation in response to a proposition or point of debate that shows an understanding of the historical problem. The response may produce an argument (from one side or comparing different sides of a debate), persuade others to a point of view, and recognise different perspectives. Features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past are all part of the historical discourse used as evidence in explanations. This form of communication requires the ability to argue a point, using historical evidence in a logical way that forms an argument in a format/mode appropriate to the purpose and audience. Types of evidence may include: student learning journals, written or oral presentations, formal structured essays, multimedia presentations, character defences, arguments for one point of view or a comparison of views/perspectives, extended writing, hypotheticals, problem-solving scenarios, individual or group debates, cognitive tests or test papers. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>
20–40%	20–30%	20–30%	Document study Historical documents are used as stimuli to develop skills in history, to explore the nature and problems of historical evidence, the nature and authenticity of historical documents, their reliability, gaps and/or validity, and the range of perspectives about historical times. Historical documents may be confronting, contradictory and challenging. Critically interrogating the nature of historical documents in the context of time period/s and the historical place, people, events and ideas includes exploring concepts of bias, inconsistency, propaganda, perspectives, motives, forces and gaps in statistics. Documents may be from within a relatively short time period, issue or theme or from over a wide period of time showing changing experiences and ideas. Documents may include: letters, official maps, propaganda posters, cartoons, photographs, paintings, statistics, buildings etc. as problem-solving tools. Representations of history are also used as secondary sources, for example, historical novels or biographies, art works, films, historical reproductions of artefacts. Types of evidence may include: marking keys, short answers, closed and open questions, timelines, test papers, or comparison charts. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4 but may also enable collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1.</i>
0–20%	20–30%	20–30%	Examination The examination comprises a combination of the Explanation and Document study assessment types. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3, 4 and some parts of course Outcome 1.</i>

Grades

Schools report student achievement in a completed unit at Stage 1, 2 or 3 in terms of grades. The following grades are used:

Grade	Interpretation
A	Excellent achievement
B	High achievement
C	Satisfactory achievement
D	Limited achievement
E	Inadequate achievement

Each grade is based on the student's overall performance for the unit as judged by reference to a set of pre-determined standards. These standards are defined by grade descriptions and annotated work samples.

The grade descriptions for this course are provided in Appendix 1. They can also be accessed, together with annotated work samples, through the Guide to Grades link on the course page of the Authority website at www.scsa.wa.edu.au

Refer to the WACE Manual for further information regarding grades.

WACE Examinations

In 2013, students in their final year who are studying at least one Stage 2 pair of units (e.g. 2A/2B) or at least one Stage 3 pair of units (e.g. 3A/3B) are required to sit an examination in this course, unless they are exempt. For 2014 and 2015, examinations for all Stage 2 pairs of units (e.g. 2A/2B) are optional.

WACE examinations are not held for Stage 1 units and/or Preliminary Stage units. Any student may enrol to sit a Stage 2 or Stage 3 examination as a private candidate.

Each examination assesses the specific content described in the syllabus for the pair of units studied.

Details of the WACE examinations in this course are prescribed in the WACE examination design briefs (pages 29–33).

Refer to the WACE Manual for further information regarding WACE examinations.

Standards Guides

Standards for this course are exemplified in Standards Guides. They include examination questions, annotated candidate responses at the 'excellent' and 'satisfactory' achievement bands, statistics for each question and comments from examiners. The guides are published on the Authority's web site at www.scsa.wa.edu.au and are accessed under Examination materials. An extranet log-in is required to view the guides.

UNIT 1AHIM

Unit description

The unit description provides the focus for teaching the specific unit content.

The focus for this unit is **people, place and time**. The object of this unit is to allow students to become aware of the broad sweep of history and our place within the historical narrative.

Students become aware of the values, beliefs and traditions within a society, the continuity between different societies and different time periods and the importance of individuals within a time period. They learn the basis of some traditions and values, and the importance of knowing one's history and heritage.

This unit introduces students to the historian's methods of finding and communicating reliable information gained from a variety of primary and secondary sources. It allows them to develop inquiry skills, develop different forms of communicating findings and to use ethical behaviour when communicating those findings.

Suggested learning contexts

Within the broad focus of **people, place and time** teachers may choose one or more of the suggested contexts (this list is not exhaustive):

People who shaped the past e.g.:

- Napoleon
- Elizabeth Macarthur
- George Washington
- The Empress Dowager Ci-Xi
- Alfred Deakin
- Emily Pankhurst
- Vladimir Lenin
- Adolf Hitler
- Joseph Stalin
- Gandhi
- Ho Chi Minh
- John Curtin
- Charles Perkins
- Eddie Mabo.

OR

Local history: choose a suburb, town or area of Western Australia. Relate the local history to Western Australia/Australia's history including Indigenous history, impact of wars, economic circumstances and migration etc.

OR

History mysteries:

- Ned Kelly—was he a hero or a common criminal?
- who sank the Lusitania?—was the Lusitania in the wrong place at the wrong time or was it a conspiracy?
- what happened to the Romanov Family?
- who killed JFK—was it one person or a conspiracy?
- Hitler's last days—what happened to his remains?

OR

- fact or fiction?—a comparison of representations of history in film and fiction with actual historical accounts.

Unit content

This unit includes knowledge, understandings and skills to the degree of complexity described below:

Historical thinking and methodology

Constructing historical inquiry

- constructing a set of focus questions for the purpose of an investigation using a selection of sources e.g. who, what, when, where, how and why
- identifying the main points of view in a given range of sources
- identifying different types of sources that can be used for an historical investigation
- a range of simple note-making strategies to record and organise information collected.

Interpreting, analysing and synthesising information

- making simple inferences based on the information collected
- connecting information gathered to current understandings and personal viewpoint
- identifying usefulness of evidence e.g. sufficiency and accuracy of evidence
- drafting conclusions using evidence that supports one or more points of view.

Communicating findings

- different forms of communication that convey historical stories and evidence e.g. recounts, displays, performance and written accounts
- selecting suitable evidence to justify a particular point of view
- types of language and communication forms suitable for presenting findings of an investigation
- ethical behaviour when recording and communicating findings e.g. recording sources.

Working with historical narrative

The impact of the following forces should be considered, where appropriate, throughout the unit:

- political
- economic
- leadership
- international relations
- social/cultural.

Elements of a society at the start of the period

- key political, social and economic structures of a society at the start of the period
- values, beliefs and traditions characteristic of a society
- chronology of the period of study according to significant events, people and ideas.

Key people, ideas, events over the period

- ideas that emerged throughout the period
- key events that occurred throughout the period
- the emergence of individuals and groups within a society, their leaders (or influences), aims and policies
- level of support or opposition for significant individuals, groups or organisations, ideas and events.

Consequences of continuity and change over the period

- nature (types) of continuity and change
- forces that bring about continuity and change e.g. political, economic, social, military, religious, technological, leadership, collective or group pressure
- identifying forces that were more significant than others in shaping continuity and change
- identifying aspects of a society that changed and those which stayed the same.

Historical explanation and representation

Explanations and representations of the past

- a variety of explanations and representations exist about past people, ideas and events at a particular time
- different methods used to convey explanations and representations of the past e.g. cartoons, film, government records, speeches and letters
- different types of evidence may reflect particular explanations and representations of the past e.g. primary, secondary, official and unofficial sources.

Understanding perspectives

- perspectives reflect individual and/or society's opinions, views, feelings and assumptions about people, events and ideas
- individual and group perspectives are shaped by values, beliefs and experiences of a society
- explanations and representations reflect different perspectives of the past.

Assessment

The four types of assessment in the table below are consistent with the teaching and learning strategies considered to be the most supportive of student achievement of the outcomes in the Modern History course. The table provides details of the assessment type, examples of different ways that these assessment types can be applied and the weighting range for each assessment type.

Weighting Stage 1	Type of assessment
30–50%	Historical inquiry Process of construction of an historical inquiry: framing or asking of a range of questions and/or constructing of a hypothesis; selection, collection and evaluation of a range of evidence (primary, secondary, historical representations) that may include evidence such as legal documents, oral, practical fieldwork and/or media material; critical analysis and interpretation of the evidence; and communicating using the discourse of History. Using historical evidence to develop an informed, balanced judgement about the past including concepts such as the impact of features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past. Findings may be communicated in different ways such as using short or extended written work, a timeline, a museum display, re-enactment of an event, recreation of historical clothing and food, completion of an historic trail, a multimedia presentation, historical debate or hypothetical. Types of evidence when focusing on the process may include: student learning journals, student annotations, student summarising tables, in combination with the final product. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1 and will also enable collection of evidence for course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>
10–30%	Explanation Explanation in response to a proposition or point of debate that shows an understanding of the historical problem. The response may produce an argument (from one side or comparing different sides of a debate), persuade others to a point of view, and recognise different perspectives. Features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past are all part of the historical discourse used as evidence in explanations. This form of communication requires the ability to argue a point, using historical evidence in a logical way that forms an argument in a format/mode appropriate to the purpose and audience. Types of evidence may include: student learning journals, written or oral presentations, formal structured essays, multimedia presentations, character defences, arguments for one point of view or a comparison of views/perspectives, extended writing, hypotheticals, problem-solving scenarios, individual or group debates, cognitive tests or test papers. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>

20–40%	Document study Historical documents are used as stimuli to develop skills in history, to explore the nature and problems of historical evidence, the nature and authenticity of historical documents, their reliability, gaps and/or validity, and the range of perspectives about historical times. Historical documents may be confronting, contradictory and challenging. Critically interrogating the nature of historical documents in the context of time period/s and the historical place, people, events and ideas includes exploring concepts of bias, inconsistency, propaganda, perspectives, motives, forces and gaps in statistics. Documents may be from within a relatively short time period, issue or theme or from over a wide period of time showing changing experiences and ideas. Documents may include: letters, official maps, propaganda posters, cartoons, photographs, paintings, statistics, buildings etc. as problem-solving tools. Representations of history are also used as secondary sources, for example, historical novels or biographies, art works, films, historical reproductions of artefacts. Types of evidence may include marking keys, short answers, closed and open questions, timelines, test papers, or comparison charts. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4 but may also enable collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1.</i>
0–20%	Examination The examination comprises a combination of the Explanation and Document study assessment types. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3, 4 and some parts of course Outcome 1.</i>

UNIT 1BHIM

Unit description

The unit description provides the focus for teaching the specific unit content.

The focus for this unit is **power and authority**. Students learn that societies consist of individuals and institutions that have various types of power and authority and that these interact with each other.

Students learn how power and authority is distributed throughout a group or society, that individuals and groups seek to influence the structures of power and authority and the difficulties of using these structures in a just or equitable manner. In learning about the structures and institutions of societies, they make comparisons and judgements about other societies and their own society.

In this unit, students develop critical thinking skills related to comparing and contrasting information, distinguish between the usefulness of sources and understand that there are different points of view and alternative accounts of history.

Suggested learning contexts

Within the broad focus of **power and authority**, teachers may choose from the suggested contexts (this list is not exhaustive):

Imperialism and colonialism—choose one or more of the following:

- the British Empire
- the British in Australia
- the Spanish in the Americas
- the French in Indo-China
- the Dutch in the East Indies.

OR

Conflict and cooperation—choose one or more of the following:

- the congress system
- League of Nations
- United Nations
- Red Cross
- Amnesty International.

OR

Authoritarian states—choose one or more of the following:

- Tokugawa Japan
- Nazi Germany
- Tsarist Russia 1855–1917.

OR

Power and authority in Australia—choose one or more of the following:

- colonial government
- federalism
- wartime governments.

Unit content

This unit includes knowledge, understandings and skills to the degree of complexity described below:

Historical thinking and methodology

Constructing historical inquiry

- general and specific questions for the purpose of an investigation
- points of view in text and non-text sources and how these are supported with fact and opinion
- strategies and methods for gathering, recording and organising data according to the type of information collected.

Interpreting, analysing and synthesising information

- comparing and contrasting information collected to separate fact from opinion
- distinguishing between different types of sources and their usefulness in the formulation of key ideas/conclusions about the investigation
- drafting simple and logical arguments using supporting evidence that presents different points of view.

Communicating findings

- ways in which points of view shape the selection and communication of evidence in alternative accounts
- selecting forms of communication to convey a particular point of view and which suits the purpose and audience
- ethical behaviour when recording and communicating findings e.g. accurately acknowledging the work of others.

Working with historical narrative

The impact of the following forces should be considered where appropriate throughout the unit:

- political
- economic
- leadership
- international relations
- social/cultural.

Elements of a society at the start of the period

- key political, social and economic structures of a society at the start of the period
- values, beliefs and traditions are linked to the identity of a society
- recognition of different kinds of power and authority that exist within a society

- identifying structures and processes of power and authority in the society
- significant events, issues, people and other factors that shaped the nature of society at the start of the period.

Key people, ideas, events over the period

- individuals and groups present challenges to the structures of power and authority as a result of events and ideas within the time period
- motivation and actions of individuals and groups seeking to influence structures of power and authority
- the structures of power and authority respond to challenges by individuals, groups and organisations.

Consequences of continuity and change over the period

- indicators of continuity and change
- how and why aspects of society change while other aspects remain unchanged
- fate of those people who either supported or resisted continuity and change in a society throughout a period.

Historical explanation and representation

Explanations and representations of the past

- explanations and representations about past people, ideas and events have similarities and differences
- advantages and limitations of different types of evidence in explaining and representing the past
- how evidence that supports particular explanations and representations of the past is shaped by a range of factors e.g. passage of time, bias, propaganda, motive and purpose.

Understanding perspectives

- different perspectives about the past exist at a particular time and place
- how values, beliefs, attitudes and other factors shape individual and group perspectives e.g. political and economic ideas, nationality, propaganda and socioeconomic status
- explanations and representations of the past are shaped by different perspectives.

Assessment

The four types of assessment in the table below are consistent with the teaching and learning strategies considered to be the most supportive of student achievement of the outcomes in the Modern History course. The table provides details of the assessment type, examples of different ways that these assessment types can be applied and the weighting range for each assessment type.

Weighting Stage 1	Type of assessment
30–50%	Historical inquiry Process of construction of an historical inquiry: framing or asking of a range of questions and/or constructing of a hypothesis; selection, collection and evaluation of a range of evidence (primary, secondary, historical representations) that may include evidence such as legal documents, oral, practical fieldwork and/or media material; critical analysis and interpretation of the evidence; and communicating using the discourse of History. Using historical evidence to develop an informed, balanced judgement about the past including concepts such as the impact of features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past. Findings may be communicated in different ways such as using short or extended written work, a timeline, a museum display, re-enactment of an event, recreation of historical clothing and food, completion of an historic trail, a multimedia presentation, historical debate or hypothetical. Types of evidence when focusing on the process may include: student learning journals, student annotations, student summarising tables, in combination with the final product. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1 and will also enable collection of evidence for course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>
10–30%	Explanation Explanation in response to a proposition or point of debate that shows an understanding of the historical problem. The response may produce an argument (from one side or comparing different sides of a debate), persuade others to a point of view, and recognise different perspectives. Features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past are all part of the historical discourse used as evidence in explanations. This form of communication requires the ability to argue a point, using historical evidence in a logical way that forms an argument in a format/mode appropriate to the purpose and audience. Types of evidence may include: student learning journals, written or oral presentations, formal structured essays, multimedia presentations, character defences, arguments for one point of view or a comparison of views/perspectives, extended writing, hypotheticals, problem-solving scenarios, individual or group debates, cognitive tests or test papers. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>

20–40%	Document study Historical documents are used as stimuli to develop skills in history, to explore the nature and problems of historical evidence, the nature and authenticity of historical documents, their reliability, gaps and/or validity, and the range of perspectives about historical times. Historical documents may be confronting, contradictory and challenging. Critically interrogating the nature of historical documents in the context of time period/s and the historical place, people, events and ideas includes exploring concepts of bias, inconsistency, propaganda, perspectives, motives, forces and gaps in statistics. Documents may be from within a relatively short time period, issue or theme or from over a wide period of time showing changing experiences and ideas. Documents may include: letters, official maps, propaganda posters, cartoons, photographs, paintings, statistics, buildings etc. as problem-solving tools. Representations of history are also used as secondary sources, for example, historical novels or biographies, art works, films, historical reproductions of artefacts. Types of evidence may include marking keys, short answers, closed and open questions, timelines, test papers, or comparison charts. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4 but may also enable collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1.</i>
0–20%	Examination The examination comprises a combination of the Explanation and Document study assessment types. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3, 4 and some parts of course Outcome 1.</i>

UNIT 2AHIM

Unit description

The unit description provides the focus for teaching the specific unit content.

The focus for this unit is **societies and change**. Students learn about the evolving nature of societies and the various forces for continuity and change that exist.

Students learn that some values, beliefs and traditions are linked to the identity of a society. They also learn that in any period of change there are those individuals and institutions that support change but others that oppose it; and that there are different interpretations of the resultant society.

In this unit, students learn to develop propositions/hypotheses with supporting arguments, use appropriate strategies for selecting, recording and organising information and question the usefulness of evidence. They communicate findings that reflect the purpose and audience of the investigation.

Unit content

This unit includes knowledge, understandings and skills to the degree of complexity described below. This is the examinable content of the course.

Prescribed learning contexts

Within the broad focus of **societies and change**, teachers choose from ONE of the following prescribed contexts:

Note: Students sitting the Stage 2 WACE examination in their final year must study the prescribed context marked with an asterisk *.

- the Industrial Revolution 1764–1900
- the American Civil War
- USA—opening up of the West 1837–1914
- the Meiji Restoration
- Victorian England—industrial, social and political change
- the unification of Germany and/or Italy
- the USA between the wars
- India from Raj to republic—a study of the end of the British Empire
- the Nuclear Age—from Hiroshima to Chernobyl
- terrorism 1946–2001

- local history—a study of how the history of a local area within Western Australia has changed due to the impact of external factors such as white settlement, economic factors, war and migration
- *Choose from **one** of the following time periods in Australian history:
 - 1880–1929
OR
 - 1920–1959
OR
 - 1950–1999.

Then study the impact of the following forces for change on Australia:

- economic
- political
- leadership
- international relations and international conflicts
- social/cultural including Aboriginal peoples, migrants, women, sport, environment
- identity.

Historical thinking and methodology

Constructing historical inquiry

- devising a range of specific and general questions for the purpose of an investigation
- developing propositions/hypotheses with supporting arguments and identifying possible relevant evidence
- selecting appropriate and relevant sources for an investigation
- using a range of strategies and methods for recording and organising information collected.

Interpreting, analysing and synthesising information

- formulating assumptions based on evidence or dominant issues/themes in the information collected
- questioning the usefulness of evidence by recognising the reliability, relevance and consistency of evidence
- drafting conclusions which link to assumptions made or the hypothesis/proposition of the investigation.

Communicating findings

- how the purpose of an investigation and the audience affect the ways in which findings are best communicated
- combining everyday language with historical discourse to suit a range of audiences using a variety of communication forms
- ethical behaviour when recording and communicating findings e.g. specific formats that are consistent with learning areas or whole school policy.

Working with historical narrative

The impact of the following forces should be considered where appropriate throughout the unit:

- political
- economic
- leadership
- international relations
- social/cultural.

Elements of a society at the start of the period

- key political, social and economic structures of a society at the start of the period
- values, beliefs and traditions that have become integral to the society
- individuals and groups who hold power and those who do not
- relative importance of events, issues, people and other factors in shaping the nature of society at that particular time.

Key people, ideas and events over the period

- relationship between events, ideas and people throughout the period
- methods and strategies used by leaders, individuals and groups seeking change
- extent of support for opposing leaders, individuals, groups or organisations and alternative ideas throughout the period.

Consequences of continuity and change over the period

- impact of historical forces on individuals and groups
- various forms of continuity and change throughout the period of study
- extent of economic, political and social change compared to the start of the period.

Historical explanation and representation

Explanations and representations of the past

- explanations and representations of past people and events may differ between societies, groups and individuals
- techniques and/or styles of presentation e.g. symbols, caricatures, film and stereotypes used to convey particular explanations and representations of the past
- provisional nature of explanations and representations of the past and how they may change over time.

Understanding perspectives

- range of perspectives that exist at a particular time will include those of dominant groups and individuals
- connections between perspectives of individuals and groups and the prevailing values, beliefs and attitudes held by the leadership within a time period

- how a range of explanations and representations reflect the different perspectives and cultural contexts of individuals and groups.

Assessment

The four types of assessment in the table below are consistent with the teaching and learning strategies considered to be the most supportive of student achievement of the outcomes in the Modern History course. The table provides details of the assessment type, examples of different ways that these assessment types can be applied and the weighting range for each assessment type.

Weighting Stage 2	Type of assessment
20–30%	Historical inquiry Process of construction of an historical inquiry: framing or asking of a range of questions and/or constructing of a hypothesis; selection, collection and evaluation of a range of evidence (primary, secondary, historical representations) that may include evidence such as legal documents, oral, practical fieldwork and/or media material; critical analysis and interpretation of the evidence; and communicating using the discourse of History. Using historical evidence to develop an informed, balanced judgement about the past including concepts such as the impact of features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past. Findings may be communicated in different ways such as using short or extended written work, a timeline, a museum display, re-enactment of an event, recreation of historical clothing and food, completion of an historic trail, a multimedia presentation, historical debate or hypothetical. Types of evidence when focusing on the process may include: student learning journals, student annotations, student summarising tables, in combination with the final product. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1 and will also enable collection of evidence for course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>
20–30%	Explanation Explanation in response to a proposition or point of debate that shows an understanding of the historical problem. The response may produce an argument (from one side or comparing different sides of a debate), persuade others to a point of view, and recognise different perspectives. Features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past are all part of the historical discourse used as evidence in explanations. This form of communication requires the ability to argue a point, using historical evidence in a logical way that forms an argument in a format/mode appropriate to the purpose and audience. Types of evidence may include: student learning journals, written or oral presentations, formal structured essays, multimedia presentations, character defences, arguments for one point of view or a comparison of views/perspectives, extended writing, hypotheticals, problem-solving scenarios, individual or group debates, cognitive tests or test papers. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>

20–30%	Document study Historical documents are used as stimuli to develop skills in history, to explore the nature and problems of historical evidence, the nature and authenticity of historical documents, their reliability, gaps and/or validity, and the range of perspectives about historical times. Historical documents may be confronting, contradictory and challenging. Critically interrogating the nature of historical documents in the context of time period/s and the historical place, people, events and ideas includes exploring concepts of bias, inconsistency, propaganda, perspectives, motives, forces and gaps in statistics. Documents may be from within a relatively short time period, issue or theme or from over a wide period of time showing changing experiences and ideas. Documents may include: letters, official maps, propaganda posters, cartoons, photographs, paintings, statistics, buildings etc. as problem-solving tools. Representations of history are also used as secondary sources, for example, historical novels or biographies, art works, films, historical reproductions of artefacts. Types of evidence may include: marking keys, short answers, closed and open questions, timelines, test papers, or comparison charts. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4 but may also enable collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1.</i>
20–30%	Examination The examination comprises a combination of the Explanation and Document study assessment types. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3, 4 and some parts of course Outcome 1.</i>

UNIT 2BHIM

Unit description

The unit description provides the focus for teaching the specific unit content.

The focus for this unit is **historical trends and movements**. Students understand that throughout history there have been events, ideas, beliefs and values that have contributed to underlying historical trends and movements.

Students understand that historical trends and movements have particular underlying ideas, that different methods and strategies are used to achieve change and that there are consequences for continuity and change. Some perspectives are omitted and others emphasised, both during the period of the trend or movement and subsequent to the trend or movement.

In this unit, students are able to justify their choice of sources, draw inferences based on key elements and communicate findings in ways that show consideration of differing perspectives and justify a particular viewpoint.

Unit content

This unit includes knowledge, understandings and skills to the degree of complexity described below. This is the examinable content of the course.

Prescribed learning contexts

Within the broad focus of **historical trends and movements**, teachers choose from ONE of the prescribed contexts:

Note: Students sitting the Stage 2 WACE examination in their final year must study one of the prescribed contexts marked with an asterisk *.

- imperialism such as Dutch/French/Spanish/British
- post-war independence movements in India/French-IndoChina/Indonesia/Africa
- globalisation such as the beginnings in the 16th century/the 19th century/Post WWII and/or Post 1989 after the collapse of the Soviet Union
- The French Revolution—Bourbon to Bonaparte
- China—the first Opium War to the Revolution of 1911
- The American Revolution 1765–1814

- *Fascism in Italy 1918–1945
- *Nazism in Germany 1918–1945
- *the Civil Rights Movement in the USA 1941–1971.

Historical thinking and methodology

Constructing historical inquiry

- formulating research questions to construct and test an hypothesis or proposition
- justifying which sources would be more appropriate for an investigation
- recording and organising information using historical conventions.

Interpreting, analysing and synthesising information

- drawing inferences based upon the key elements in information collected e.g. origin, audience, language, symbols, accuracy and perspective
- assessing the usefulness of evidence when drawing conclusions from corroborating and/or conflicting evidence
- drafting conclusions that convert inferences, predictions or informed guesses, with the use of evidence, into key findings.

Communicating findings

- how points of view impact on the way historical debates and issues are communicated
- ways to communicate the findings of an historical inquiry to show differing perspectives and justification of a particular viewpoint using supporting evidence
- ethical behaviour when recording and communicating findings e.g. accepted formats used across organisations.

Working with historical narrative

The impact of the following forces should be considered where appropriate throughout the unit:

- political
- economic
- leadership
- international relations
- social/cultural.

Elements of a society at the start of the period

- key political, social and economic structures of a society at the start of the period
- values, beliefs and traditions that have changed or remained the same
- means by which individuals and groups have gained power and authority
- the relationship between events, ideas, people and other factors underlying the nature of the society to that point.

Key people, ideas and events over the period

- events that contributed to the development of particular movements or trends throughout the period
- key ideas underlying movements or trends, what they were, and how they were articulated by groups and their leaders
- methods and strategies used by leaders, individuals and groups to achieve their aims.

Consequences of continuity and change over the period

- the impact of special circumstances or situations on various forms of continuity and change
- consequences of historical movements or trends on political, cultural, social, military and legal structures within a society throughout the period of study
- the effectiveness of individuals and groups in achieving their aims
- evidence of continuity of and/or change to the values, beliefs and attitudes of a society as a result of historical movements or trends.

Historical explanation and representation

Explanations and representations of the past

- explanations and representations of the past are influenced by contemporary issues and ideas
- strengths and weaknesses of different techniques and/or styles of presentation (e.g. symbols, caricatures, film and stereotypes) and evidence used to explain and represent the past
- how explanations and representations of the past are interpreted and constructed by individuals and groups over time e.g. the influence of social memory in the constructing and maintaining a version of history.

Understanding perspectives

- some perspectives are emphasised while others are omitted
- how individual and group experiences contribute to the formation of different perspectives about the past
- how specific perspectives are evident in accepted or prevailing explanations and representations of the past.

Assessment

The four types of assessment in the table below are consistent with the teaching and learning strategies considered to be the most supportive of student achievement of the outcomes in the Modern History course. The table provides details of the assessment type, examples of different ways that these assessment types can be applied and the weighting range for each assessment type.

Weighting Stage 2	Type of assessment
20–30%	Historical inquiry Process of construction of an historical inquiry: framing or asking of a range of questions and/or constructing of a hypothesis; selection, collection and evaluation of a range of evidence (primary, secondary, historical representations) that may include evidence such as legal documents, oral, practical fieldwork and/or media material; critical analysis and interpretation of the evidence; and communicating using the discourse of History. Using historical evidence to develop an informed, balanced judgement about the past including concepts such as the impact of features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past. Findings may be communicated in different ways such as using short or extended written work, a timeline, a museum display, re-enactment of an event, recreation of historical clothing and food, completion of an historic trail, a multimedia presentation, historical debate or hypothetical. Types of evidence when focusing on the process may include: student learning journals, student annotations, student summarising tables, in combination with the final product. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1 and will also enable collection of evidence for course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>
20–30%	Explanation Explanation in response to a proposition or point of debate that shows an understanding of the historical problem. The response may produce an argument (from one side or comparing different sides of a debate), persuade others to a point of view, and recognise different perspectives. Features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past are all part of the historical discourse used as evidence in explanations. This form of communication requires the ability to argue a point, using historical evidence in a logical way that forms an argument in a format/mode appropriate to the purpose and audience. Types of evidence may include: student learning journals, written or oral presentations, formal structured essays, multimedia presentations, character defences, arguments for one point of view or a comparison of views/perspectives, extended writing, hypotheticals, problem-solving scenarios, individual or group debates, cognitive tests or test papers. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>

20–30%	Document study Historical documents are used as stimuli to develop skills in history, to explore the nature and problems of historical evidence, the nature and authenticity of historical documents, their reliability, gaps and/or validity, and the range of perspectives about historical times. Historical documents may be confronting, contradictory and challenging. Critically interrogating the nature of historical documents in the context of time period/s and the historical place, people, events and ideas includes exploring concepts of bias, inconsistency, propaganda, perspectives, motives, forces and gaps in statistics. Documents may be from within a relatively short time period, issue or theme or from over a wide period of time showing changing experiences and ideas. Documents may include: letters, official maps, propaganda posters, cartoons, photographs, paintings, statistics, modern buildings etc. as problem-solving tools. Representations of history are also used as secondary sources, for example, historical novels or biographies, art works, films, historical reproductions of artefacts. Types of evidence may include: marking keys, short answers, closed and open questions, timelines, test papers, or comparison charts. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4 but may also enable collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1.</i>
20–30%	Examination The examination comprises a combination of the Explanation and Document study assessment types. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3, 4 and some parts of course Outcome 1.</i>

UNIT 3AHIM

Unit description

The unit description provides the focus for teaching the specific unit content.

The focus for this unit is **cohesion and division**. Students learn that there are internal and external forces that result in cohesion and/or division within Australian society and these have consequences for continuity and change.

Students assess how the structures of power and authority lead to cohesion and/or division, how different groups and individuals responded and whether there was greater cohesion or division evident in Australian society as a result.

Students develop the skill of drafting conclusions or findings that present balanced arguments. Such conclusions show a consideration of different perspectives and acknowledge the problematical nature of the construction and accuracy of past explanations and representations.

Unit content

This unit includes knowledge, understandings and skills to the degree of complexity described below. This is the examinable content of the course.

Prescribed learning contexts

Within the broad focus of **cohesion and division**, teachers must choose ONE of the following time periods in the Australian History context:

- 1880–1929
OR
- 1920–1959
OR
- 1950–1999.

Note: Students may not repeat a time period studied previously in Stage 2.

Historical thinking and methodology

Constructing historical inquiry

- constructing and modifying an hypothesis or a proposition to be used as a focus for an investigation
- using evidence to draft preliminary reasoned arguments to support propositions/hypotheses
- devising strategies for the gathering, recording, organising, testing and analysing of evidence.

Interpreting, analysing and synthesising information

- making inferences based upon patterns, trends and representations in evidence
- evaluating the usefulness of evidence when constructing arguments and conclusions
- drafting conclusions or findings that present balanced arguments showing a consideration of the differing perspectives presented by others.

Communicating findings

- how values, beliefs and ideologies impact on the way findings are communicated
- ways to communicate findings that examine competing perspectives and their interpretation of supporting evidence
- use of recording and communication forms that meet externally set standards (e.g. accurately observing established conventions and protocols) which suit the type of audience and purpose of communication.

Working with historical narrative

Study the impact of the following forces, where appropriate, on cohesion and division in Australia:

- economic
- political
- leadership
- international relations and international conflicts
- social/cultural including Aboriginal peoples, migrants and women
- identity.

Elements of a society at the start of the period

- key political, social and economic structures of the society at the start of the period
- challenges to the values, beliefs and traditions that exist at the start of the period of study
- the impact of resistance to and acceptance of power and authority upon groups and individuals
- events, ideas, people and other factors that have shaped Australian society to that point.

Key people, ideas and events over the period

- examples of cohesion and division within Australian society throughout the period
- the role of individuals and groups leading to cohesion and/or division within the period
- types of groups or organisations that supported or resisted change and their reasons (motives) for doing so
- extent that structures of power and authority were used to bring about cohesion and/or division.

Consequences of continuity and change over the period

- extent to which cohesion and division have consequences for continuity
- extent to which cohesion and division have consequences for change

- impact of cohesive and divisive forces on individuals, families, groups and broader community.

Historical explanation and representation

Explanations and representations of the past

- forces that assist and hinder explanations and representations about the past e.g. political correctness, cultural mindsets and survival of some evidence over others
- manipulation of techniques and/or styles of presentation used in evidence to explain and represent the past
- problematic nature of the construction and accuracy of past explanations and representations e.g. changing and emerging evidence over time, accounts that may be generalised, sensationalised, biased, mythologised or anachronistic.

Understanding perspectives

- different perspectives can present a limited view which can misrepresent the past, either unconsciously or deliberately
- how individual and group perspectives are shaped by different motives and purposes
- explanations and representations of the past may be manipulated or influenced by different perspectives.

Assessment

The four types of assessment in the table below are consistent with the teaching and learning strategies considered to be the most supportive of student achievement of the outcomes in the Modern History course. The table provides details of the assessment type, examples of different ways that these assessment types can be applied and the weighting range for each assessment type.

Weighting Stage 3	Type of assessment
20–30%	Historical inquiry Process of construction of an historical inquiry: framing or asking of a range of questions and/or constructing of a hypothesis; selection, collection and evaluation of a range of evidence (primary, secondary, historical representations) that may include evidence such as legal documents, oral, practical fieldwork and/or media material; critical analysis and interpretation of the evidence; and communicating using the discourse of History. Using historical evidence to develop an informed, balanced judgement about the past including concepts such as the impact of features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past. Findings may be communicated in different ways such as using short or extended written work, a timeline, a museum display, re-enactment of an event, recreation of historical clothing and food, completion of an historic trail, a multimedia presentation, historical debate or hypothetical. Types of evidence when focusing on the process may include: student learning journals, student annotations, student summarising tables, in combination with the final product. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1 and will also enable collection of evidence for course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>
20–30%	Explanation Explanation in response to a proposition or point of debate that shows an understanding of the historical problem. The response may produce an argument (from one side or comparing different sides of a debate), persuade others to a point of view, and recognise different perspectives. Features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past are all part of the historical discourse used as evidence in explanations. This form of communication requires the ability to argue a point, using historical evidence in a logical way that forms an argument in a format/mode appropriate to the purpose and audience. Types of evidence may include: student learning journals, written or oral presentations, formal structured essays, multimedia presentations, character defences, arguments for one point of view or a comparison of views/perspectives, extended writing, hypotheticals, problem-solving scenarios, individual or group debates, cognitive tests or test papers. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>

20–30%	Document study Historical documents are used as stimuli to develop skills in history, to explore the nature and problems of historical evidence, the nature and authenticity of historical documents, their reliability, gaps and/or validity, and the range of perspectives about historical times. Historical documents may be confronting, contradictory and challenging. Critically interrogating the nature of historical documents in the context of time period/s and the historical place, people, events and ideas includes exploring concepts of bias, inconsistency, propaganda, perspectives, motives, forces and gaps in statistics. Documents may be from within a relatively short time period, issue or theme or from over a wide period of time showing changing experiences and ideas. Documents may include: letters, official maps, propaganda posters, cartoons, photographs, paintings, statistics, buildings etc. as problem-solving tools. Representations of history are also used as secondary sources, for example, historical novels or biographies, art works, films, historical reproductions of artefacts. Types of evidence may include marking keys, short answers, closed and open questions, timelines, test papers, or comparison charts. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4 but may also enable collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1.</i>
20–30%	Examination The examination comprises a combination of the Explanation and Document study assessment types. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3, 4 and some parts of course Outcome 1.</i>

UNIT 3BHIM

Unit description

The unit description provides the focus for teaching the specific unit content.

The focus for this unit is **ideas that shaped history**. The object of this unit is to explore the power of ideas and ideologies as forces for change and/or their use to reinforce dominant elements in society.

Knowledge about the evolution and spread of significant ideas assists students to understand the beliefs and values of a society and to what extent these ideas have been cohesive or divisive. They are also able to determine which ideas were forces for continuity and change.

Students are able to identify and evaluate sources that contain a range of viewpoints and interpretations of the ideas being studied and be able to discuss how changing perspectives about past events, people and ideas challenge explanations and representations of the past.

Unit content

This unit includes knowledge, understandings and skills to the degree of complexity described below. This is the examinable content of the course.

Prescribed learning contexts

Within the broad focus of **ideas that shaped history**, teachers must choose from ONE of the prescribed contexts:

- the Russian Revolution—Autocracy, Marxism, Leninism and Stalinism (1900–1941)
OR
- the Chinese Revolution—Nationalism, Marxism, Maoism and Dengism (1920–1989)
OR
- the Cold War in Europe—Communism, Capitalism, Democracy, Containment, Peaceful Coexistence, Détente, Glasnost and Perestroika (1945–1991)
OR
- conflict in the Middle East—Imperialism, Arab Nationalism, Zionism, Fundamentalism and Terrorism (1940–1993).

Historical thinking and methodology

Constructing historical inquiry

- formulating research questions that focus on motive/purpose, perspective and interpretation
- developing a proposal for an investigation that describes the processes to be implemented as part of an investigation
- identifying and evaluating sources that contain a range of viewpoints, perspectives and interpretations.

Interpreting, analysing and synthesising information

- formulating assumptions based upon patterns, trends and representations presented in perspectives of others e.g. historians, writers and journalists
- identifying possible alternative interpretations that can be drawn from the evidence
- formulating reasoned and supported conclusions that recognise and explain ambiguities and problematic issues in evidence.

Communicating findings

- forms of communication used to convey a historical position which seeks to persuade, manipulate or inform a specific audience or range of audiences
- ways to communicate findings that examine popular and competing historical representations and the basis for these views
- use of recording and communication forms that meet externally set standards (e.g. accurately observing established conventions and protocols) which suit the type of audience and purpose of communication.

Working with historical narrative

The impact of the following forces on the acceptance or rejection of ideas by individuals and groups should be considered where appropriate:

- political
- economic
- leadership
- international relations
- social/cultural.

Elements of a society at the start of the period

- key political, social and economic structures of a society or region at the start of the period
- how values, beliefs and traditions have been manipulated or used to reinforce dominant elements of a society or region
- relationship between structures of power and authority and its legitimacy (or acceptance) within the society or region
- events, ideas, people and other factors that have had wider influences within or beyond a society or region.

Key people, ideas and events over the period

- key influences on the emergence of significant people, events and ideas within a society or region throughout the period of study
- evolution and the spread of events and ideologies within and/or beyond a society or region
- extent to which ideas, events, leadership and other influences were cohesive or divisive within a society or region.

Consequences of continuity and change over the period

- role of ideas and ideologies as forces for continuity and/or change in society
- changing political, economic and social circumstances of individuals and groups in a society or region throughout the time period
- people, events and ideas which influenced changes
- shifts in the balance of power, authority and legitimacy at the national and/or international level.

Historical explanation and representation

Explanations and representations of the past

- debates about the past reflect the nature, context, aims and purposes of historians and others e.g. their identity, class, time, place, experiences, status, reputation, beliefs and values
- techniques and/or styles of presentation used to manipulate the way people interpret evidence and form perspectives about the past e.g. how evidence may be used to support political or ideological ends
- how history is constructed and recorded changes over time as a result of the changing nature, availability and interpretation of historical evidence.

Understanding perspectives

- changing perspectives about past events, people and ideas can challenge accepted explanations and representations
- similar and different perspectives are shaped by beliefs, ideas, philosophies and ethics across time and place
- changing and evolving perspectives of individuals over time influence the construction of conflicting or alternative explanations and representations of past people, events and ideas.

Assessment

The four types of assessment in the table below are consistent with the teaching and learning strategies considered to be the most supportive of student achievement of the outcomes in the Modern History course. The table provides details of the assessment type, examples of different ways that these assessment types can be applied and the weighting range for each assessment type.

Weighting Stage 3	Type of assessment
20–30%	Historical inquiry Process of construction of an historical inquiry: framing or asking of a range of questions and/or constructing of a hypothesis; selection, collection and evaluation of a range of evidence (primary, secondary, historical representations) that may include evidence such as legal documents, oral, practical fieldwork and/or media material; critical analysis and interpretation of the evidence; and communicating using the discourse of History. Using historical evidence to develop an informed, balanced judgement about the past including concepts such as the impact of features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past. Findings may be communicated in different ways such as using short or extended written work, a timeline, a museum display, re-enactment of an event, recreation of historical clothing and food, completion of an historic trail, a multimedia presentation, historical debate or hypothetical. Types of evidence when focusing on the process may include: student learning journals, student annotations, student summarising tables, in combination with the final product. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1 and will also enable collection of evidence for course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>
20–30%	Explanation Explanation in response to a proposition or point of debate that shows an understanding of the historical problem. The response may produce an argument (from one side or comparing different sides of a debate), persuade others to a point of view, and recognise different perspectives. Features and organisational structures of a time period, causes and effects, cultural influences, key people, ideas and events, forces, motives, perspectives, interpretations, and representations of the past are all part of the historical discourse used as evidence in explanations. This form of communication requires the ability to argue a point, using historical evidence in a logical way that forms an argument in a format/mode appropriate to the purpose and audience. Types of evidence may include: student learning journals, written or oral presentations, formal structured essays, multimedia presentations, character defences, arguments for one point of view or a comparison of views/perspectives, extended writing, hypotheticals, problem-solving scenarios, individual or group debates, cognitive tests or test papers. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4.</i>

20–30%	Document study Historical documents are used as stimuli to develop skills in history, to explore the nature and problems of historical evidence, the nature and authenticity of historical documents, their reliability, gaps and/or validity, and the range of perspectives about historical times. Historical documents may be confronting, contradictory and challenging. Critically interrogating the nature of historical documents in the context of time period/s and the historical place, people, events and ideas includes exploring concepts of bias, inconsistency, propaganda, perspectives, motives, forces and gaps in statistics. Documents may be from within a relatively short time period, issue or theme or from over a wide period of time showing changing experiences and ideas. Documents may include: letters, official maps, propaganda posters, cartoons, photographs, paintings, statistics, buildings etc. as problem-solving tools. Representations of history are also used as secondary sources, for example, historical novels or biographies, art works, films, historical reproductions of artefacts. Types of evidence may include: marking keys, short answers, closed and open questions, timelines, test papers, or comparison charts. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3 and 4 but may also enable collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcome 1.</i>
20–30%	Examination The examination comprises a combination of the Explanation and Document study assessment types. <i>Best suited to the collection of evidence on student achievement of course Outcomes 2, 3, 4 and some parts of course Outcome 1.</i>

Examination details Stage 2 and Stage 3

Modern History

Examination design brief

Stage 2

Time allowed

Reading time before commencing work: ten minutes
Working time for paper: three hours

Permissible items

Standard items: pens (blue/black preferred), pencils (including coloured), sharpener, correction fluid/tape, eraser, ruler, highlighters
Special items: nil

Additional information

A document booklet containing source material is provided.

Section	Supporting information
Section One Document study—Unit 2A 25% of the total examination One question Suggested working time: 45 minutes	The question consists of five parts that could be structured as a series of open and/or partially open questions. This question is applicable to all time periods and requires the candidate to apply understandings by discussing and explaining the source material. The candidate responds using source material chosen from one of the three Australian time periods listed below: • Australia 1880–1929 • Australia 1920–1959 • Australia 1950–1999. There are six sources per time period. There is a common theme across the sources in the three time periods. Suitable source material could include photographs, cartoons, paintings, graphs, government papers, newspaper sources, letters, secondary sources etc. Comparable source material is used in the three time periods and is placed in the same order e.g. the first source is an image, the second is a text source etc.
Section Two Essay—Unit 2A 25% of the total examination One question from a choice of three Suggested working time: 45 minutes	The question requires the candidate to draw on their knowledge and understandings of one of the three time periods. The questions could either be in two parts or scaffolded.
Section Three Document study—Unit 2B 25% of the total examination One question Suggested working time: 45 minutes	The question consists of five parts that could be structured as a series of open and/or partially open questions. This question is applicable to all contexts and requires the candidate to apply understandings by discussing and explaining the source material. The candidate responds using the source material chosen from one of the unit learning contexts listed below: • Fascism in Italy 1918–1945 • Nazism in Germany 1918–1945 • The Civil Rights Movement in the USA 1941–1971. There are three sources per unit learning context. At least one of these sources must allow for the identification of the context. Suitable source material could include photographs, cartoons, paintings, graphs, government papers, newspaper sources, letters, secondary sources etc. Comparable source material is used in the three time periods and is placed in the same order e.g. the first source is an image, the second is a text source etc.

Section Four Essay—Unit 2B 25% of the total examination One question from a choice of three Suggested working time: 45 minutes	The question requires the candidate to draw on their knowledge and understandings of one of the three unit learning contexts. One question from a set of three questions for: Fascism in Italy 1918–1945 and Nazism in Germany 1918–1945 OR One question from a set of three questions for: The Civil Rights Movement in the USA 1941–1971 Questions common to both sets are not precluded. The questions could either be in two parts or scaffolded.
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Modern History

Examination design brief

Stage 3

Time allowed

Reading time before commencing work: ten minutes
Working time for paper: three hours

Permissible items

Standard items: pens (blue/black preferred), pencils (including coloured), sharpener, correction fluid/tape, eraser, ruler, highlighters
Special items: nil

Additional information

A document booklet containing source material is provided.

Section	Supporting information
Section One Document study—Unit 3A 25% of the total examination One question Suggested working time: 45 minutes	The question consists of five parts which could be structured as a series of open and/or partially open questions. This question is applicable to all time periods and requires the candidate to apply understandings by critically analysing and evaluating the source material. The candidate responds using source material chosen from one of the three Australian time periods listed below: • Australia 1880–1929 • Australia 1920–1959 • Australia 1950–1999. There are seven sources with one source for each time period showing broad perspectives, interpretations or historiography. There is a common theme across the sources in the three time periods. Suitable source material could include photographs, cartoons, paintings, graphs, government papers, newspaper sources, letters, secondary sources etc. Comparable source material is used in the three time periods and is placed in the same order e.g. the first source is an image, the second is a text source etc.
Section Two Essay—Unit 3A 25% of the total examination One question from a choice of three Suggested working time: 45 minutes	The question requires the candidate to draw on their knowledge and understandings of one of the three time periods.
Section Three Document study—Unit 3B 25% of the total examination One question Suggested working time: 45 minutes	The questions consist of four parts that could be structured as a series of open and/or partially open questions. This question is applicable to all contexts and requires the candidate to apply understandings by critically analysing and evaluating the source material. The candidate responds using the source material chosen from one of the unit learning contexts listed below: • Ideas that shaped the Russian Revolution—Autocracy, Marxism, Leninism and Stalinism (1900–1941) • Ideas that shaped the Chinese Revolution—Nationalism, Marxism, Maoism and Dengism (1920–1989) • Ideas that shaped the Cold War in Europe—Communism, Capitalism, Democracy, Containment, Peaceful Co-existence, Détente, Glasnost and Perestroika (1945–1991) • Ideas that shaped conflict in the Middle East—Imperialism, Arab Nationalism, Zionism, Fundamentalism and Terrorism (1940–1993). There are two sources per unit learning context. Suitable source material could include photographs, cartoons, paintings, graphs, government papers, newspaper sources, letters, secondary sources etc. Comparable source material is used in the three time periods and is placed in the same order e.g. the first source is an image, the second is a text source etc.

Section	Supporting information
Section Four Essay—Unit 3B 25% of the total examination One question from a choice of three Suggested working time: 45 minutes	The question requires the candidate to draw on their knowledge and understandings of one of the four unit learning contexts. One question from a set of three questions for: Ideas that shaped the Russian Revolution—Autocracy, Marxism, Leninism and Stalinism (1900–1941) and Ideas that shaped the Chinese Revolution—Nationalism, Marxism, Maoism and Dengism (1920–1989) OR One question from a set of three questions for: Ideas that shaped the Cold War in Europe—Communism, Capitalism, Democracy, Containment, Peaceful Co-existence, Détente, Glasnost and Perestroika (1945–1991) and Ideas that shaped conflict in the Middle-East—Imperialism, Arab Nationalism, Zionism, Fundamentalism and Terrorism (1940–1993) Questions common to both sets are not precluded.

Appendix 1: Grade descriptions

Grade descriptions

Modern History

Stage 1



School Curriculum
and Standards
Authority

A	Historical thinking and methodology Selects a range of appropriate sources and analyses for one or more of the following: accuracy, bias, omissions and differences in viewpoint. Responds to key words in research or essay questions and is mostly accurate in applying evidence and historical understandings from acknowledged resources. Uses appropriate historical terms and concepts to develop clear arguments which are logical and coherent, with an attempt at analysis. Working with historical narrative Demonstrates that one or more of the following: people/events/ideas and/or structures are more significant than the others and have direct consequences within a society. Historical explanation and representation Identifies that different historical perspectives exist both within the time period studied and over time.
B	Historical thinking and methodology Selects a range of appropriate sources and begins to analyse for one or more of the following: accuracy, bias and different viewpoints. Begins to respond to key words in research or essay questions, applying a limited historical understanding of acknowledged resources and evidence. Uses appropriate historical terms and develops a structured response which is largely narrative. Working with historical narrative Demonstrates that one or more of the following: people/events/ideas and/or structures, have direct consequences within a society. Historical explanation and representation Identifies that various perspectives of history exist.
C	Historical thinking and methodology Selects a narrow range of sources that generally relate to the topic, and attempts to interpret for one or more of the following: accuracy, bias and different viewpoints. Responds to some aspects of the research or essay question; selects and acknowledges resources but uses limited supporting evidence. Recounts a number of the major features of the narrative and develops a limited structure for the argument/discussion. Working with historical narrative Demonstrates, to some extent, the relationship between people and/or events. Historical explanation and representation: Identifies that different points of view of an historical event/issue exist.
D	Historical thinking and methodology Selects sources from a narrow range, which may or may not be relevant, and provides a limited interpretation for one or more of the following: accuracy, bias and different viewpoints. Attempts to respond to the question, but with a limited or inaccurate interpretation of the resource material. Demonstrates minimal knowledge of the historical narrative and the structural conventions. Working with historical narrative Identifies that there are people/events and/or ideas that characterise a time period. Historical explanation and representation Identifies a simple perspective of an historical event.
E	Does not meet the requirements of a D grade.

Grade descriptions

Modern History Stage 2



School Curriculum
and Standards
Authority

A	Historical thinking and methodology Selects a range of sources and analyses these for accuracy, bias, omissions and differences in viewpoint. Responds to key words in research or essay questions, accurately applying evidence and historical understandings from appropriately acknowledged resources. Uses appropriate historical terms and concepts to develop cohesive arguments which are analytical, logical and coherent. Working with historical narrative Assesses the extent to which one or more of the following: people/events/ideas and/or structures, have direct and indirect consequences within and/or between societies. Historical explanation and representation: Identifies and explains why historical perspectives change.
B	Historical thinking and methodology Selects a range of sources and begins to analyse for accuracy, bias, and different viewpoints. Begins to respond to key words in research or essay questions, applying some evidence and historical understandings from appropriately acknowledged resources. Uses appropriate historical terms and concepts and develops an argument which is logical, coherent and largely narrative. Working with historical narrative Describes how one or more of the following: people/events/ideas and/or structures, have direct consequences in different societies. Historical explanation and representation: Explains why various perspectives of history exist.
C	Historical thinking and methodology Selects a limited range of sources and makes an assessment of accuracy, bias and different viewpoints. Responds to some aspects of the research or essay question; selects and acknowledges resources but makes limited use of supporting evidence. Recounts the major features of the narrative and provides a simple structure for the argument/discussion. Working with historical narrative Identifies simple interactions between people/events/ideas and/or structures. Historical explanation and representation Identifies some different points of view of history.
D	Historical thinking and methodology Selects sources from a narrow range, which may or may not be relevant, and makes statements about accuracy, bias and different viewpoints. Responds to one or two aspects of the question. Shows limited range and depth in selecting resources and evidence to support statements, and limited interpretation and acknowledgement of the resources. Demonstrates a limited knowledge of the historical narrative and the structural conventions. Working with historical narrative Identifies that there are people/events/ideas and/or structures that characterise a time period. Historical explanation and representation Identifies one perspective of an historical event.
E	Does not meet the requirements of a D grade.

Grade descriptions

Modern History

Stage 3



School Curriculum
and Standards
Authority

A	Historical thinking and methodology Selects a comprehensive range of sources and analyses these for accuracy, bias, omissions and differences in viewpoint. Responds to key words in research or essay questions, effectively applying evidence and historical understandings from appropriately acknowledged resources. Uses appropriate historical terms and concepts to develop sustained arguments which are analytical, logical and coherent. Working with historical narrative Evaluates the extent to which forces (including people, events, ideas and structures) have direct and indirect consequences within and/or between societies. Historical explanation and representation Explains how historical perspectives change within and between time periods.
B	Historical thinking and methodology Selects a range of sources and analyses for accuracy, bias, and different viewpoints. Responds to key words in research or essay questions, applying evidence and historical understandings from appropriately acknowledged resources. Uses appropriate historical terms and concepts and develops an argument which is logical, coherent and largely narrative. Working with historical narrative Explains how forces (including people, events, ideas and structures) have direct consequences within and/or between societies. Historical explanation and representation Explains why various perspectives of history exist within and between time periods.
C	Historical thinking and methodology Selects a limited range of sources and begins to analyse for accuracy, bias and different viewpoints. Responds to some aspects of the research or essay question; selects and acknowledges resources and uses supporting evidence. Recounts the major features of the narrative and provides a structure for the argument/discussion. Working with historical narrative Identifies that there is interaction between forces (including people, events, ideas and structures) in a time period. Historical explanation and representation Identifies and describes different perspectives of history.
D	Historical thinking and methodology Selects sources from a narrow range, which may or may not be relevant, and makes an attempt to analyse for accuracy, bias and different viewpoints. Endeavours to respond to the question; acknowledges some resources but displays limited application of evidence. Demonstrates some knowledge of the historical narrative and the structural conventions. Working with historical narrative Demonstrates, to a limited degree, the relationship between people, events, ideas and structures. Historical explanation and representation Identifies at least one perspective of an historical event.
E	Does not meet the requirements of a D grade.